FIGHTERBASE

Keto

Diet guide

Very low carb, high fat.



Prepared 10 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

> DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

How to use this diet guide

This diet guide is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Keto**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

> Looking for the full list of foods? Download the **Full food list** PDF from the same screen. It names every allowed and avoided food.

THE BASICS

What is Keto?

Carbs kept very low (often under 50 g a day) so the body runs mainly on fat and ketones. Meals are built from fat and protein with low-carb veg.

Where it comes from

The ketogenic diet was developed in the 1920s at the Mayo Clinic and elsewhere as a treatment for epilepsy. Today it is a very low-carb, high-fat way of eating that tries to move the body into ketosis, where it burns fat and makes ketones for fuel.

The main ideas

1. Carbohydrate stays very low, usually 20 to 50 g net carbs a day.
2. Protein is moderate. Fat makes up most of the energy.
3. Net carbs = total carbs minus fibre. Count them.
4. It takes days to a couple of weeks to adapt.
5. Hidden carbs in sauces, drinks and 'diet' foods can end ketosis.

Who it suits

- People who want strict, structured low-carb eating
- People who like fewer food decisions and fewer snack cravings
- Some people with medical guidance for specific conditions

Talk to your doctor or a registered dietitian first if:

- You take medication for diabetes (risk of low blood sugar or ketoacidosis), blood pressure or epilepsy
- You have kidney, liver, pancreas or gall bladder problems, or have no gall bladder
- You are pregnant, breastfeeding or under 18
- You have ever had an eating disorder
- You plan to cut weight for a fight (keto is not a safe shortcut)

TRAINING

Fuel for training

- Keto can feel hard in high-intensity rounds. Expect lower top-end speed for the first weeks while you adapt.
- Some athletes use a targeted version: a small amount of fast carbs (about 15 to 30 g) around hard sessions. Ask a sports dietitian before trying it.
- Salt, fluids and magnesium matter much more than usual: headaches, cramps and 'keto flu' are often a salt problem.
- Eat enough: low appetite on keto can slide into under-fuelling.

> Low-intensity training adapts fairly well over a few weeks. High-intensity rounds often suffer, which is why some fighters add carbs around hard sessions (a targeted approach).

Nutrients to keep an eye on

Sodium, potassium, magnesium
avoid cramps, headaches and poor sleep
Where: salt, broth, avocado, spinach, nuts, a supplement if advised

Fibre
gut health
Where: non-starchy vegetables, chia, flax

Omega-3
joint and brain health
Where: oily fish, walnuts, flax

B vitamins and vitamin C
energy and recovery
Where: meat, eggs, peppers, broccoli

Common mistakes

- Not replacing salt and fluid early on
- Eating too much protein and too little fat, or the reverse
- Counting total carbs instead of net carbs, or not counting at all
- Trusting 'keto' labels without checking
- Relying on bacon and cheese only, with no vegetables

EVERYDAY LIFE

Labels, eating out and swaps

Reading labels

- Starch and sugar hide as: maltodextrin, dextrose, glucose syrup, modified starch, wheat flour, honey, fruit juice
- Sugar alcohols (maltitol, sorbitol) partly count towards carbs
- Check sauces, marinades, soups and processed meats for added sugar

Eating out

- Steak, burger without bun, grilled fish or chicken with a green side.
- Ask for butter or olive oil on vegetables.
- Say 'no bread, no potatoes, no rice'.
- Beware sauces (ketchup, BBQ, sweet chilli) and dressings with sugar.

Easy swaps

Rice	→	Cauliflower rice
Potato	→	Mashed cauliflower or celeriac
Bread	→	Cloud bread or lettuce wrap
Pasta	→	Courgetti or shirataki
Milk in coffee	→	Double cream or unsweetened almond milk

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

A sample week

One way a week could look. Portions and total food depend on you and your training.

	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner
Mon	Eggs fried in butter, bacon, avocado	Chicken salad with olive oil	Salmon, asparagus, hollandaise
Tue	Full-fat Greek yoghurt, a few berries, nuts	Tuna and egg salad	Beef burger, no bun, side salad
Wed	Omelette, cheese, spinach	Soup with cream (no potato)	Pork belly, cabbage
Thu	Sausages, mushrooms, eggs	Prawn salad with avocado	Chicken thighs, broccoli, butter
Fri	Chia pudding made with coconut milk	Leftover chicken and salad	Steak, green beans, garlic butter
Sat	Smoked salmon, cream cheese, cucumber	Ham and cheese roll-ups with salad	Lamb chops, courgette, mint yoghurt
Sun	Bacon, eggs, tomatoes	Cobb salad	Roast chicken, cauliflower mash, greens

Snacks

Cheese · Boiled eggs · Olives · Nuts (macadamia, pecan, walnut) · Pork scratchings · Jerky (no sugar) · Avocado · Celery and nut butter

Shopping list

Eggs, meat, fish · Butter, cream, hard cheese · Avocado, leafy greens, courgette, cauliflower, broccoli · Olive oil, coconut oil · Nuts and seeds · Salt, herbs, spices · Electrolyte or magnesium supplement if advised

GOOD TO KNOW

Questions people ask

What is keto flu?

Headaches, tiredness and cramps in the first week or two. Often eased by more water and salt.

Do I need to measure ketones?

No. It is optional. How you feel and perform matters more.

Is it safe long term?

Evidence is mixed. Long-term use is best done with medical or dietitian oversight.

Further reading

British Dietetic Association; Epilepsy Society; peer-reviewed reviews of ketogenic diets in sport.

For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

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